

考研精读 | The Guardian



Wildfires to rise by at least 39% in Europe by 2100 without action

若不采取行动，到 2100 年欧洲野火或将至少增加 39%

难度评级：★★★★☆

【 Para.1 】

Wildfires are **projected** to burn 39% more of Europe by the end of the century even in the best-case **scenario** for stopping the planet from heating unless action is taken to manage them better, a study has found.

一项研究发现，如果不采取行动进一步管控野火，即使在遏制全球变暖的最佳情景下，到本世纪末，欧洲境内受野火影响的面积预计还将增加 39%。

【 Para.2 】

The increase in hot, dry and windy weather that leads to small fires turning into raging **infernos** is to **engulf** more of Europe as carbon pollution pushes temperatures higher. In the worst-case scenario the researchers modelled, in which

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文章导读：

本文中的研究预测，即便在相对乐观控温情景下，欧洲本世纪末野火过火面积仍将增长 39%；若升温达 3.6℃，过火面积近乎增至三倍。优化火情管控可大幅缓解灾情，但无法抵消气候变暖带来的影响。当下欧洲野火肆虐，过度灭火反而累积可燃物，催生破坏力更强的特大火灾。

project v. /prəˈdʒekt/ To estimate or forecast a future amount or trend based on present data. 预测，推算（熟词僻义，常见义为“项目；投射”）【考研英语词汇】

The economy is **projected** to grow by 2% next year. 预计明年经济将增长2%。

scenario n. /səˈnɑːriəʊ/ A possible situation or sequence of events; an imagined plan. 设想，情景；方案【考研英语词汇】

inferno n. /ɪnˈfɜːnəʊ/ A large dangerous fire; a place or situation like hell. 火海；地狱般的地方

engulf v. /ɪnˈɡʌlf/ To surround or cover something completely, especially in a harmful way. 吞没，吞噬

The flames **engulfed** the entire building within minutes. 大火几分钟内就吞没了整栋建筑。

moderate v. /ˈmɒdəreɪt/ To make something less extreme, intense or severe. 使缓和，减轻（熟词僻义，形容词义为“温和的”）【考研英语词汇】

The central bank raised rates to **moderate** inflation. 央行加息以抑制通货膨胀。

eradicate v. /ɪˈrædɪkeɪt/ To destroy or get rid of something completely. 根除，消灭

The campaign aims to **eradicate** polio worldwide. 该运动旨在全球范围内根除脊髓灰质炎。

emission n. /ɪˈmɪʃn/ The act of releasing gas, heat, etc. into the air; the substance released. 排放；排放物【考研英语词汇】

mitigation n. /ˌmɪtɪˈgeɪʃn/ The act of making something less harmful, severe or painful. 减缓，缓解

ravage v. /ˈrævɪdʒ/ To damage something badly; to destroy something. 肆虐，毁坏

blaze n. /bleɪz/ A large fire that causes a lot of damage. 大火，烈火

hectare n. /ˈhekteə(r)/ A unit for measuring area, equal to 10,000 square metres. 公顷

driver n. /ˈdraɪvə(r)/ A factor that causes something to happen or change. 驱动因素（熟词僻义，常见义为“司机”）【考研英语词汇】

cap v. /kæp/ To limit the amount of something, especially as a maximum. 限制（上限），封顶（熟词僻义，名词义为“帽子”）【考研英语词汇】

The government **capped** rents to protect tenants. 政府限制租金上限以保护租客。

global heating would reach 3.6C above pre-industrial levels, the burnt area would almost triple.

随着碳排放推高气温，炎热、干燥且多风的天气增多，导致小规模火灾演变为熊熊烈火，将吞噬欧洲更多区域；在研究人员模拟的最坏情景下，若全球升温幅度较工业化前水平高出 3.6° C，过火面积几乎增至原来的三倍。

【 Para.3 】

Improvements in fire management could **moderate** those increases by more than 70%, the study found, but not **eradicate** them entirely.

研究发现，改进火灾管理可将增幅降低七成以上，却无法彻底消除。

【 Para.4 】

“Investments into fire management could help to a certain limit, but if we go on a path of high **emissions** ... we still see strong increases in burnt area,” said Maik Billing, an ecosystem researcher at the Potsdam Institute for Climate Impact Research (PIK) and lead author of the study. “Fire management cannot replace climate **mitigation**.”

“火灾管理投入能在一定程度上起到作用，但若继续走高排放路径……过火面积仍会大幅增加，”该研究的第一作者、波茨坦气候影响研究所（PIK）的生态系统研究员马伊克·比林表示，“火灾管理无法取代气候减缓的措施。”

temper v. /'tempə(r)/ To make something less severe or extreme. 使缓和，调节（熟词僻义，名词义为“脾气”）【考研英语大纲词汇】

Optimism must be **tempered** with realism. 乐观须以现实加以调节。

proxy n. /'prɒksi/ A person or thing used to represent or measure something else. 替代指标；代理人

extrapolate v. /ɪk'stræpəleɪt/ To estimate an unknown quantity by extending known information. 推断，外推

It is risky to **extrapolate** from a small sample. 从小样本进行外推是有风险的。

suppression n. /sə'preʃn/ The act of preventing something from being expressed, developing or continuing. 压制，扑灭【考研英语大纲词汇】

paradoxically adv. /'pærə'dɒksɪkli/ In a way that is surprising because it is the opposite of what you would expect. 矛盾地，似是而非地【考研英语大纲词汇】

Paradoxically, the stricter rules made the problem worse. 矛盾的是，更严格的规定反而使问题恶化。

residual adj. /rɪ'zɪdʒuəl/ Remaining after the main part has gone or been taken away. 残留的，剩余的

ferocious adj. /fə'rəʃəs/ Very fierce, violent or intense. 凶猛的，猛烈的【考研英语大纲词汇】

rage v. /reɪdʒ/ To continue with great force or violence. 肆虐，狂暴地延续（熟词僻义，名词义为“愤怒”）【考研英语大纲词汇】

The debate about the new policy **raged** for weeks. 关于新政策的争论激烈持续了数周。

extinguish v. /ɪk'stɪŋgwɪʃ/ To make a fire stop burning; to put out a fire. 扑灭，熄灭【考研英语大纲词汇】

It took the firefighters a whole day to **extinguish** the blaze. 消防员花了一整天才扑灭这场大火。

accompany v. /ə'kʌmpəni/ To happen or exist at the same time as something else. 伴随，与……同时发生（本义为“陪伴，陪同”）【考研英语大纲词汇】

Thunder **accompanied** the heavy rain. 大雨伴随着雷声。

scapegoating n. /'skeɪpgəʊtɪŋ/ The act of blaming a person or group for something that is not their fault. 找替罪羊，归罪他人

【 Para.5 】

The research comes as wildfires continue to **ravage** Europe, with large **blazes** hitting northern European countries such as the UK, Belgium and Germany after weeks in which France, Spain, Italy, Croatia and Greece battled monster infernos.

该研究发布之际，野火仍在持续肆虐欧洲：法国、西班牙、意大利、克罗地亚和希腊已与特大山火奋战数周，如今英国、比利时、德国等纬度更靠北的国家也爆发了大范围山火。

【 Para.6 】

Across the EU, this fire season is on course to become the third-worst on record, behind 2025 and 2022, according to data published by the European Forest Fire Information Service yesterday.

欧洲森林火灾信息服务中心昨日发布的数据显示，本次火灾季在欧盟范围内将成为有记录以来第三严重的火灾季，仅次于 2025 年和 2022 年。

【 Para.7 】

More than 600,000 **hectares** have burned so far, with records broken for this time of year in Belgium, France and Slovakia.

迄今已有逾 60 万公顷土地被焚毁，比利时、法国和斯洛伐克均打破了同期火灾纪录。

►今日句子分析

(Para.17) Víctor Resco de Dios, a forestry engineer at the University of Lleida, who was not involved in the study, said the fire season was often accompanied by an “unproductive blame game” – isolating only one of the two key factors whose interaction results in wildfires – and that the study was a reminder to move beyond scapegoating. 莱里达大学林业工程师维克托·雷斯科·德·迪奥斯未参与该研究。他指出，火灾季常伴随着于事无补的相互指责：人们仅归咎于引发野火的两项核心因素之一，却忽略野火是二者共同作用所致；该研究警示我们，应跳出一味寻找替罪羊的思维定式。



主句：

主语 - Víctor Resco de Dios (西班牙人名)；

同位语 - a forestry engineer at the University of Lleida (名词短语作同位语，补充说明主语身份)；

谓语 - said；

非限制性定语从句 - who was not involved in the study；

从句主语 - Who

从句谓语 - was not involved in

从句宾语 - the study

宾语从句 1 - the fire season was often accompanied by an “unproductive blame game” (引导词 that 被省略)；

从句主语 - the fire season；

从句谓语 - was often accompanied by (被动语态，often 为频率状语)；

插入语 - isolating only one of the two key factors (现在分词短语，由两个破折号隔开，解释 blame game 的具体内涵)；

定语从句 - whose interaction results in wildfires (whose 引

【 Para.8 】

The researchers, who compared the projected annual burnt area in Europe in 2070-2100 with modelled results for the period from 2000 to 2030, found that the increase in fire weather was the biggest **driver** of change.

研究人员将 2070 至 2100 年间欧洲预计的年度过火面积与 2000 至 2030 年间的模拟结果进行对比后发现，火灾天气增多是变化的最大驱动因素。

【 Para. 9 】

In the optimistic scenario, in which global heating is **capped** at 1.8C above pre-industrial levels, a little above the current level of 1.4C, some regions showed moderate increases in fire weather while others experienced little change.

在较为乐观的情景下，即全球升温较工业化前水平高出 1.8℃，略高于当前 1.4℃，部分地区的火险天气仅略有增加，另一些地区则几乎不变。

【 Para.10 】

In the pessimistic scenario, however, with 3.6C of heating by the end of the century, the researchers found consistent worsening of fire weather across “virtually all of Europe”.

而在悲观情景下，即到本世纪末升温 3.6℃，研究人员发现“几乎整个欧洲”的火险天气都在持续恶化。

【 Para.11 】

导，修饰 the two key factors)；

从句主语 - whose interaction

从句谓语 - results in

从句宾语 - wildfires

并列连词 - and (连接 said 后的两个并列宾语从句)；

宾语从句2 - that the study was a reminder to move beyond scapegoating；

引导词 - that (不可省略，第二个宾语从句须保留引导词)；

从句主语 - the study；

从句系动词 - was；

从句表语 - a reminder；

后置定语 - to move beyond scapegoating (动词不定式短语作后置定语，说明 reminder 的内容)。

翻译技巧解析：本句翻译主要运用了长句拆分、词性转换、语境化词义重构与逻辑显化等翻译策略。原文是包含插入语、定语从句和破折号解释成分的英文复合长句，译文首先将后置的非限定性定语从句 “who was not involved in the study” 独立拆分出来，打破英文头重脚轻的句式结构，顺应中文先交代人物背景、再引出观点的表达习惯；对于 “unproductive blame game” 不要直译为 “无成效的指责游戏”，而是结合野火治理的公共议题语境，翻译为 “于事无补的相互指责”；原文破折号后长达一行的定语从句 “isolating only one of the two key factors whose interaction results in wildfires” 暗含因果转折逻辑，翻译时通过增译转折连词 “却”，把隐藏在英文关系从句里的深层对立关系显性化，点明片面归因与忽视多因素耦合作用之间的矛盾；最后的 “move beyond scapegoating” 不要简单译作 “超越找替罪羊”，转译为 “跳出一味寻找替罪羊的思维定式”，通过补充 “思维定式” 这一范畴词，将英文简短动词短语背后所指的固有认知局限完整传达出来。

Scientists expect current policies to result in about 2.6C of global heating by the end of the century.

科学家预计，按现行政策，到本世纪末全球将升温约 2.6℃。

【 Para.12 】

Using a second model, the researchers found that continued improvements in fighting fires could **temper** the effects of worsening fire weather, reducing burnt area by 92% in the cooler scenario compared with firefighting efforts remaining at today's levels.

借助第二个模型，研究人员发现，灭火能力的持续改进可缓解火险天气恶化带来的影响：在升温幅度较小的情景下，与灭火水平维持在当前相比，过火面积可减少 92%。

【 Para.13 】

The researchers used the Human Development Index as a **proxy** for firefighting ability, but acknowledged that the rise of mega-fires had made it hard to **extrapolate** from past experience.

研究人员用人类发展指数作为灭火能力的替代指标，但同时也承认，巨型火灾频发使得过往经验难以用于推断。

【 Para.14 】

➤ 写作积累

(Para.6) Across the EU, this fire season is on course to become the third-worst on record, behind 2025 and 2022.

on course to do sth. phr. Likely to achieve or end up as something, judging by the current trend. 势将……，按目前趋势即将成为……。course 本义为“航线、航向”，on course 即“行驶在既定航线上”，引申为“朝着预期目标推进”。与 be likely to 相比，这一表达更具动态画面感，是新闻英语的高频用法。例：The economy is on course to grow by 3% this year. 今年经济势将增长 3%。

类似的表达还有：**be set to do sth.** 即将……，预计将……。例：The new regulation is set to take effect next month. 新规将于下月生效。**be on track to do sth.** 正朝着……稳步推进。例：The company is on track to hit its sales target. 公司正朝着销售目标稳步迈进。**be bound to do sth.** 必然……，注定……（语气最强）。例：Without reform, the system is bound to collapse. 不改革，这套体系必然崩溃。

语言知识补充：与 on course 相对的是 go off course（偏离轨道）；本句中的 on record（有记录以来）同样是高频搭配，如 the third-worst on record（有记录以来第三严重）、the hottest year on record（有记录以来最热的一年），阅读中常用于破纪录语境中。

(Para.16) Such monster fires hit France and Spain in late July this year, forcing a third of a million people from their homes.

a third of a million 分数 + of + 大数（约数表达），即三分之一百万，约合 33 万。英语中“分数词 + of + 整数”可灵活生成约数，比精确数字更符合新闻语体：a third of a million（约 33 万）、half a million（50 万）、a quarter of a million（25 万）、three quarters of a billion（7.5 亿）。写作中恰当使用可避免数字堆砌的生硬感。例：The flood affected nearly half a million residents. 洪水影响了近 50 万居民。

类似的表达还有：**some / roughly / nearly + 精确数字**。例：Some 330,000 people were displaced by the floods. 约 33 万人因洪水流离失所。in the region of + 数字（口语色彩较浓的“大约”）。例：The project cost is in the region of \$2 million. 该项目耗资约 200 万美元。

语言知识补充：英语分数表达的口诀是“分子用基数词、分母用序数词，分子大于一时分母加 s”：one third（三分之一）、two fifths（五分之二）；但“一半”固定用 half，“四分之一”也常用 a quarter。另须注意，a third of a million 中的 million 不加 s，因为前面有具体数量限定；只有 millions of（数以百万计）这类约数结构才用复数。

Improvements in fire **suppression** since the 1980s have reduced the number of fires and the area burnt in southern Europe, a study found this month, but the enthusiastic **suppression** of fires, even small ones, has **paradoxically** increased the residual fuel load.

本月一项研究发现，自 20 世纪 80 年代以来，火灾扑救手段的改进减少了南欧的火灾次数与过火面积；但即便是对小型火情的极力扑救，却事与愿违地增加了剩余可燃物载量。

【 Para.15 】

This has allowed fires to develop to extreme levels when conditions are favourable, resulting in fewer but more **ferocious** fires.

这意味着一旦条件允许火势便会发展到极端水平，火灾数量因此更少，但单场火灾的威力却更为猛烈。

【 Para.16 】

Such monster fires hit France and Spain in late July this year, forcing a third of a million people from their homes as blazes **raged** with a force firefighters were unable to **extinguish**.

今年 7 月下旬，法国、西班牙遭遇此类特大野火，大火肆虐，消防员难以扑救，33 万人被迫疏散。

【 Para.17 】

Victor Resco de Dios, a forestry engineer at the University of Lleida, who was not involved in the study, said the fire season was often **accompanied** by an “unproductive blame game” – isolating only one of the two key factors whose interaction results in wildfires – and that the study was a reminder to move beyond **scapegoating**.

莱里达大学林业工程师维克托·雷斯科·德·迪奥斯未参与该研究。他指出，火灾季常伴随着于事无补的相互指责：人们仅归咎于引发野火的两项核心因素之一，却忽略野火是二者共同作用所致；该研究警示我们，应跳出一味寻找替罪羊的思维定式。

【 Para.18 】

“The problem of wildfires wouldn’t be worsening if we were heading towards an ice age – instead of global warming,” he said. “And it would have been largely mitigated if our landscapes were like they were a century ago, with a much smaller forest area.”

“如果我们正走向的是冰河期而非全球变暖，野火问题本不会愈演愈烈，”他说，“倘若我们的自然景观仍如一个世纪前（森林面积比现在小得多），这一问题本可大幅缓解。”